

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

options to the way that I now prioritized things, and the forces that I was now wise to. I realized that I had far more knowledge, and my automatic responses to things were different, that I was making better, more positive decisions without even really trying.

That is what I'd like you to do, as the concluding part of this first, difficult but necessary step. I'd like you to begin the process of learning to trust yourself again. You can't just opt out of earning and spending money in everyday life, and you can't achieve financial wellbeing if you're constantly second-guessing every decision.

There are lots of suggested ways for people to rediscover their gut instinct – that strong feeling that's supposed to tell us what to do whenever we need to make a choice, but in my experience, what you actually need to try to do is turn down the volume on all of the other voices vying for your attention in order to be able to actually hear yourself. In the digital age, an age where we're exposed to tens of thousands of different opinions and viewpoints every time we go online, where we are chased around the internet by brands clamouring to tell us why we *need* their product, those other voices can be so loud that our own instincts are reduced to the tiniest squeak. We're so preoccupied by what others are doing, what others think we should be doing, that we become disconnected from our own internal compass and lose sight of our own priorities. If we can't hear ourselves think, how can we even contemplate trusting ourselves? In her memoir, *Untamed*, Glennon Doyle